[METRIC]
A-A-135B
April 22, 1992
SUPERSEDING
A-A-135A
November 12, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

OPENER, LETTER, HAND (METAL)

The General Services Administration, Office Supplies and Paper Products Commodity Center, New York, NY 10278, has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in lieu of Federal Specification GG-O-588, which has been cancelled.

This description covers Letter Openers for general office use.

1. **SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:**

Letter Openers shall:

A. Be fabricated from case hardened, through hardened, or stainless steel; or, any commercially appropriate, corrosion resistant metal.

B. Have straight or offset blades, similar to Figures 1 and 2 in Section 6.

C. Have all corners, including the handle end, smoothly rounded.

D. Be a total of 22.9 ± 1.3 centimeters (9 ± 1/2 inches) long: 15.2 ± 0.6 centimeters (6 ± 1/4 inches) for the blade and 7.6 ± 0.6 centimeters (3 ± 1/4 inches) for the handle.

E. Have a blade of uniform width or slightly tapered from 1.0 centimeter (3/8-inch) maximum to 0.5 centimeter (3/16-inch) minimum starting from the blade handle to a point 2.5 centimeters (1-inch) from the tip.

F. Have a blade tapered from a point 2.5 ± 0.6 centimeters (1 ± 1/4 inches) from the blade tip and be sufficiently dulled or rounded so as not to present a hazard to the users while being used for the purpose intended.

Distribution Statement A:
Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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G. Have a handle 1.9 ± 0.3 centimeters (3/4 ± 1/8 inches) wide, if straight. Or, if tapered, handle shall taper from a maximum 2.2 centimeters (7/8-inch) at the handle end to a minimum 1.3 centimeters (1/2-inch) wide at the blade-handle junction.

H. Have a blade no less than 0.2 centimeter (1/16-inch) thick.

I. Have a handle that is either flat or decorative. If flat, handle shall be no less than 0.2 centimeter (1/16-inch) thick; and if decorative, no more than 1.3 centimeters (1/2-inch) thick. Note: If handles are decorative, they shall be made of plastic, hard rubber, metal, bone or wood. Decorative handles should be affixed to the blade so as not be become loose with use, causing the blade to twist or fall off.

J. Have a blade, not sharpened, but bevelled on both edges so as to permit envelopes to be slit without tearing.

K. Have a straight blade with a maximum allowable bow of .2 centimeter (1/16-inch), when measured from a flat surface.

Workmanship: The Letter Openers shall be free of any defects which may adversely affect the appearance, impair serviceability or which might present a personal hazard to the user, including, but not limited to, superfluous coating of any kind, burrs, niches, scratches, discoloration or rough or sharp edges. The handle (whether metal, plastic, hard rubber, bone or wood) shall also be free of defects, including, but not limited to, burrs, niches, dents, rough or sharp edges, scratches, blisters, crinkling, imbedded foreign matter, splinters, slivers, discoloration or imperfections which will impair serviceability or adversely affect the appearance or which might constitute a personal hazard to the user.

Corrosion Resistance: All metal shall be resistant to corrosion. The entire Letter Opener (if fabricated from metal) or the blade (if designed with a decorative handle) shall be either corrosion resistant stainless steel or anodized, plated, finished with baked enamel, subjected to a bluing process, or whatever is commercially appropriate. The contractor shall provide a manufacturer's chemical certification of corrosion resistance upon request by the Government.

2. **APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS AND DOCUMENT SOURCES:** The following documents form a part of this Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123, Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)

Single copies of this Commercial Item Description, or other Commercial Item Descriptions required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston; New York; Philadelphia; Washington, D. C.; Atlanta; Chicago; Kansas City, MO; For Worth; Houston; Denver; Los Angeles; San Francisco; and Auburn, WA. In addition, documents may be obtained from GSA Specifications Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20407.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-129, Marking for Shipment and Storage

Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

Public Law:

Public Law 94-580, Resource Conservation and Recovery Act, is part of U. S. Code, Title 42. Copies of the U. S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

3. **REGULATORY REQUIREMENT:** The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

4. **QUALITY ASSURANCE:**

A. Responsibility for Inspection: Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all the inspection requirements of this CID. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements (See Section 6, Ordering Data).

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B. **Sampling:** All sampling shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

(1) **Sampling for Visual Inspection.** A random sample of Letter Openers shall be taken from each lot. The inspection level shall be S-4 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one Letter Opener.

(2) **Sampling for Dimensional Inspection.** A random sample of Letter Openers shall be taken from each lot. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one Letter Opener.

(3) **Sampling for Preparation for Delivery.** For examination of the preparation for delivery. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

C. **Inspections.**

(1) **Visual Examination.** Samples taken in accordance with paragraph 4.B.1 shall be examined to verify that the superficial product characteristics are in compliance with Section 1.

(2) **Dimensional Examination.** Samples taken in accordance with paragraph 4.B.2 shall be examined to verify that all dimensionally measurable product requirements are in compliance with Section 1.

(3) **Examination for Preparation for Delivery.** Samples taken in accordance with paragraph 4.B.3 shall be examined to determined compliance with Section 5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY.

A. Packaging and Packing Provisions. Each Letter Opener shall be packaged to prevent damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. Packaged Letter Openers shall be packed in accordance with normal commercial practice. The packing container shall be closed to prevent accidental opening and shall be such to insure carrier acceptable and safe delivery to destination, complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation to be used.

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B. Marking.

(1) For Shipment to Civilian Agencies. In addition to any special marking required by contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar Code marking is required, unless otherwise specified (See Section 6).

(2) For Shipment to Military Activities. In addition to any special marking required by contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar Code marking is required, unless otherwise specified (See Section 6).

6. NOTES.

A. Ordering Data: Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(1) Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.

(2) Arrangement for inspections and inspection facilities, if different than provisions under Quality Assurance.

(3) Special packaging and packing, if different than provisions in Packaging and Packing.

(4) Special marking, if different than provisions in Marking.

(5) Specify, only if Bar Code marking is not required.

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Climate/Durability Associated:

B. Figures 1 and 2:

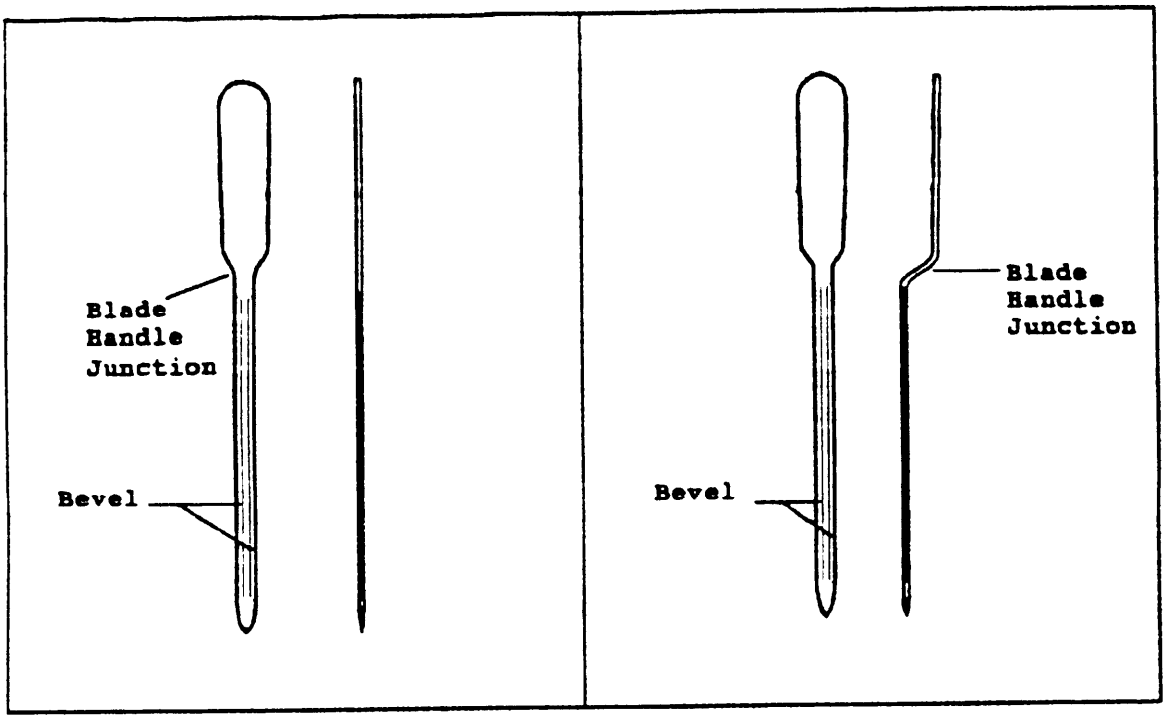


Figure 1 Figure 2

Figures are provided to depict blade and handle configuration, but are not intended to be restrictive.

MILITARY INTEREST:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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